

When Jesus wept

Text: William Billings, *The New-England Psalm-Singer*, 1770

Music: William Billings, *The New-England Psalm-Singer*, 1770

WHEN JESUS WEPT 8.8.8.8

The musical score is written for a single voice on a treble clef staff with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/2 time signature. It consists of four staves, each beginning with a measure number (1, 2, 3, 4) in the upper left corner. The lyrics are written below the notes, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across multiple notes. The melody is characterized by long, flowing lines with many ties, suggesting a slow, contemplative tempo. The final staff ends with a double bar line.

1
When Je - sus wept, the fall - ing tear

2
in mer - cy flowed be - yond all bound.

3
When Je - sus groaned, a trem - bling fear

4
seized all the guilt - y world a - round.

A four-voice round: each voice enters in turn, one measure apart.